56,000 km long and has a maximum width of 800–1,500 km.

## Ocean trench

The long, narrow, steep-sided depressions formed by tectonic forces beneath the abyssal plain are called Ocean trenches. Oceanic trenches actually extend 3 to 4 km below the level of the abyssal plain. There are 26 oceanic trenches in the world: 22 in the Pacific Ocean, 3 in the Atlantic Ocean and only one in the Indian Ocean. The Challenger Deep in the Mariana Trench, (10,994 m) in the Pacific Ocean is the deepest part of the earth. A trench forms along the convergent boundary where one plate subducts below the other (Figure 5.9).

## Island

An island is a landmass surrounded by water on all sides. Islands may be formed on the continental shelf or as oceanic islands. Most of the oceanic islands are volcanic in origin. Group of islands

**Major Ocean Trenches of the world**

| S. No | Name of the Trench | Location | Depth ( in Metres) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Challenger in Mariana Trench | North Pacific Ocean | 10,994 |
| 2. | Aldrich or Tonga Trench | South Pacific Ocean | 10,882 |
| 3. | Kurile Trench | North Pacific Ocean | 10,554 |
| 4. | Tizar Romanche Trench | South Atlantic Ocean | 7,761 |
| 5. | Sunda Trench | East of Indian Ocean | 7,450 |

*Source:* Geology.com

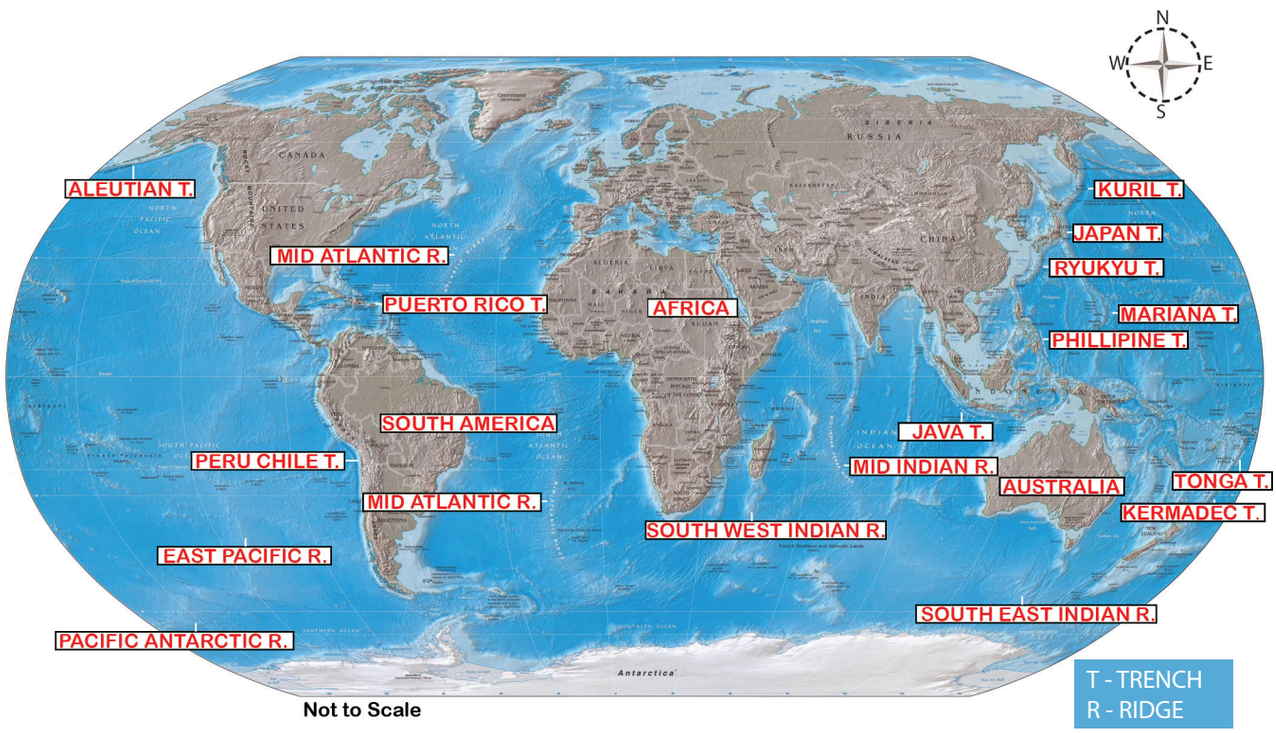



**Figure 5.9** Ridges and Trenches of the world



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